SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT

The idea of sustainable development found roots in the thinking of some scholars, popularly known as 'Club of Rome' in the year 1972. They argued that if the pattern of limitless growth continued, then there would arise problems of sustainability.

The same year, the United Nations Conference on the Human Environment (also known as the **Stockholm Conference**) was held under the auspices of the United Nations in Stockholm Sweden, during 5–16 June 1972. There were serious concerns about the patterns of ongoing limitless development as the world was becoming incapable of supporting and sustaining present rates of economic and population growth vis-à-vis resource depletion and ecological crisis. It was the UN's first major conference on international environmental issues, and marked a turning point in the development of international environmental politics. The Conference was opened and addressed by the Swedish Prime Minister Olof Palme and the UN Secretary-General, Kurt Waldheim to discuss the state of the global environment. It is recognized as the beginning of modern political and public awareness of global environmental problems. It was attended by the representatives of 113 countries, 19 inter-governmental agencies, and more than 400 inter-governmental and non-governmental organizations.

The landmarks, however, in the sustainable development thinking are obviously the *World Conservation Strategy* (1980), *Our Common Future* (1987), and *Caring for the Earth (*1991).[5]

The World Conservation Strategy (WCS) was prepared in the 1970s by the International Union for the Conservation of Nature and Natural Resources (IUCN), the World Wildlife Fund (WWF), and the United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP), and published in 1980. It represented a shift in thinking about conservation as it highlighted cure for the loss of wildlife species and habitats rather than prevention. It upheld that both conservation and development were the key to a sustainable society. The WCS identified three objectives for conservation. The first two were *maintenance of essential ecological processes* and *preservation of genetic diversity*. The third